

Copilot Prompt Handout — Session 1 (Basic Licence)

From Questions to Action — Working in Copilot Chat

For basic-licence users (Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat). Demo files referenced are fictional and provided in the session pack.

How to use this handout

Copilot Chat is your secure AI assistant — it knows the web, and it knows whatever you bring it. On a basic licence it does not read your mailbox or files on its own, so the trick is to bring the content to Copilot: paste the text, or upload the file.

- Each scenario gives three options — pick by how much time and back-and-forth you want.
- Option A is a quick win; Option B is the balanced version; Option C is a richer, interactive prompt.
- Where a prompt says [paste] or [upload], copy the email text in, or upload the file, first.
- Always read and adjust the result before you use it — you keep the final word.

Tip: stronger prompts include a goal, context, a source (what you pasted), and the output you expect.

What a basic licence includes (and what the full add-on adds)

Basic licence = Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat, included with eligible Microsoft 365 business subscriptions. Based on Microsoft's licensing documentation (current as of June 2026) — confirm what is enabled in the Deloitte Central Europe tenant.

Capability	Basic — Copilot Chat	Full — M365 Copilot add-on
Secure AI chat, enterprise data protection	Yes	Yes
Grounded in web data	Yes	Yes
Grounded in your work data (mailbox, files, meetings)	Only what you upload or paste	Full, automatic across your data
Work / Web mode toggle	No (web-grounded; you bring work content)	Yes
File upload, Copilot Pages, image creation	Yes (standard access)	Yes (priority access)
Mailbox-wide Summarize / Draft inside Outlook	Depends on tenant; bring content into Chat	Yes
Advanced agents (Researcher, Analyst, custom)	No (covered in Session 2 for licensed users)	Yes

Bottom line for today: Copilot Chat is secure and powerful when you BRING the content to it — paste it, or upload the file. It will not reach into your mailbox on its own.

1. First contact & trust — open Copilot Chat

Option A · Quick (low interaction) — warm-up

What can you help me with at work? Give me five everyday examples.

Option B · Standard — trust check

What can you help me with in my workday? Keep it practical, and tell me how my data is protected when I use you here.

Option C · Interactive (high engagement) — class-sourced

Ask me 3 quick questions about my role, then suggest five ways I could use you this week – ranked by time saved.

2. Think it through & draft

Option A · Quick (low interaction) — one-liner

Give me three ways to open a difficult message to a client about a delayed timeline.

Option B · Standard — draft from notes

Turn these rough notes into a short, professional message. Notes: [paste 3-4 bullet points]. Keep it under 120 words and end with a clear next step.

Option C · Interactive (high engagement) — compare options

From these notes, draft two versions of the message – one warm, one firm. Notes: [paste]. Then tell me when I'd use each, and ask me which to refine.

3. Write a great prompt (Goal · Context · Source · Expectations)

Option A · Quick (low interaction) — goal only

Draft a weekly client status update email.

Option B · Standard — goal + context + expectations

Draft a weekly client status update for a steering committee. Context: operating-model programme, week 4 of 10 just completed. Executive tone, under 150 words; cover progress, one risk with mitigation, decisions needed, and next steps.

Option C · Interactive (high engagement) — full four-part + source

Help me write a weekly client status update.
Goal: a short email for the client steering committee.
Context: operating-model programme, week 4 of 10 just completed.
Source: use only the notes I paste below – [paste].
Expectations: executive tone, under 150 words; progress, one risk with mitigation, decisions needed, next steps. Ask me clarifying questions first.

4. Bring your content in — upload or paste a file

Option A · Quick (low interaction) — brief before a call

I'm a manager and need to get across this report quickly before a leadership call. [Upload or paste the report] Summarize it in five bullet points, in plain business language, focused on performance and the main risks.

Option B · Standard — structured pre-read

I'm preparing for a quarterly leadership review and want to brief myself on this report. [Upload or paste the report] Give me the three key messages, the main risks with their mitigations, and two questions I should be ready to answer – concise and business-ready, and flag anything that looks unclear or missing.

Option C · Interactive (high engagement) — summary + probe areas

I'm a manager reviewing this report ahead of a partner discussion. [Upload or paste the report] First give me a five-line executive summary in a neutral, confident tone, then point me to the two areas you think I should probe – and wait for my follow-up questions before going deeper.

5. Email — summarize a long thread (paste it into Copilot Chat)

Option A · Quick (low interaction) — catch-up summary

I've just been added to this client email thread and need to catch up before I reply. [Paste the thread] Summarize it in five lines and list the actions that are mine, in plain language.

Option B · Standard — decisions & actions

I'm the engagement manager on this client account and need to know exactly where this thread landed. [Paste the thread] Summarize what it's about, the decisions made, the action items with owners, and any dates – then tell me clearly what is being asked of me. Keep it tight and factual.

Option C · Interactive (high engagement) — brief + reply plan

I'm preparing to reply to this client thread and want to get it right. [Paste the thread] First give me a short brief – what it's about, the decisions, and what's needed from me – then propose how I should respond and what to confirm. Use a professional tone, and ask me any clarifying questions before you draft anything.

6. Email — draft a reply (then paste it back into Outlook)

Option A · Quick (low interaction) — confirm & lead with decisions

I'm the engagement manager replying to a client sponsor on this thread. [Paste the thread] Draft a short, professional reply that confirms we'll bring a one-page cost case and leads with the three decisions for Thursday – under 120 words, executive tone.

Option B · Standard — concise + warmer option

I need to reply to this client email and want to sound confident and reassuring without over-promising. [Paste the email] As the engagement manager, draft a concise reply that confirms the next steps and adds a clear deadline, then give me a slightly warmer alternative opening line – keep it under 130 words.

Option C · Interactive (high engagement) — three tones to choose

I'm replying to a nervous client sponsor and want to choose my tone carefully. [Paste the email] Draft three versions of the reply – concise, warm, and formal – each under 120 words and ending with a clear next step. Then recommend which one fits a nervous sponsor and why, and refine that version based on my feedback.

7. Improve your work — Prompt Coach & Idea Coach

Option A · Quick (low interaction) — rewrite a weak prompt

I'm new to writing prompts and want to learn by example. [Paste a weak prompt] Rewrite it as a stronger prompt that includes a clear goal, context, source, and expectations – then tell me briefly what you changed and why.

Option B · Standard — coach & compare

I'm trying to get better results from Copilot. [Paste my prompt and the answer it gave] Acting as a prompt coach, suggest a stronger version that adds whatever goal, context, source, or expectations are missing, explain what you changed, then run your improved version so I can compare.

Option C · Interactive (high engagement) — idea coach

I'm a manager who needs to write a client update but I'm stuck on the angle. [Paste a few facts or notes] Acting as an idea coach, give me three different angles, each with a one-line pro and con, in a professional tone – then ask me which one to build out before you draft anything.